

SITUATIONAL AWARENESS AND PERSONAL SAFETY

Production Travel
Safety Training

MODULE AIMS

- Understand good situational awareness and how to maintain it
- Become aware of some fundamentals of personal safety
- Understand the early warning signs of aggression
- Become aware of when and how to deploy de-escalation techniques

SITUATION AWARENESS

- **R**ecognise a threat
- **E**valuate your position
- **A**void the threat
- **D**efuse the situation
- **E**xit the area



AVOIDING TROUBLE

- Avoid routines and using the same routes
- Seek local knowledge of risk areas and cultural sensitivities
- Wear sensible clothing for the area, don't wear expensive looking items
- Look and act confident, don't be distracted and trust your instincts
- Low profile is best

PERSONAL SAFETY STRATEGIES

- Understand the influence your identity may have on your safety
- Identify or create a safe space or area
- Attempt to preserve gender anonymity
- Use the door 'spy holes' and chains

PERSONAL SAFETY STRATEGIES

- Don't be afraid to draw attention to yourself if you feel uncomfortable
- Make a fuss, shout 'fire!', head for other, perhaps gendered, social groups
- A personal alarm may stun an aggressor and give a few moments to escape
- Don't leave drinks unattended
- If feeling strange, you should go to a safe place, hospital or call an ambulance

PERSONAL SAFETY STRATEGIES

- Research localised threats considering your identity
- Consider your response to unwelcome remarks
- Identify safe spaces
- Is an incident reportable?
- 'Shark' watch

CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

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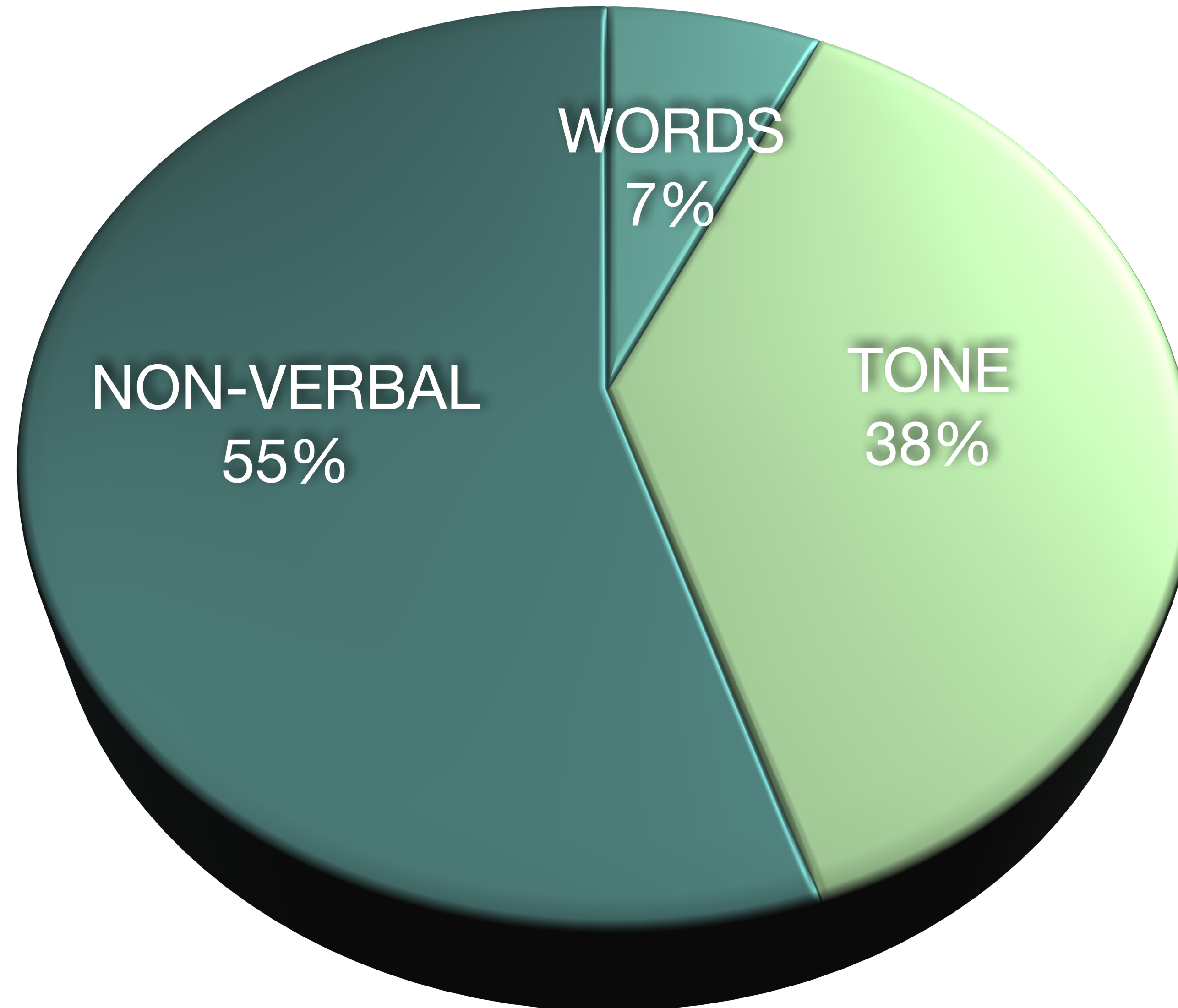
PLANNING TO AVOID CONFLICT

- Understand the causes, types, and stages of conflict
- Think through potential conflict scenarios
- Research context and the people
- Recognise, Evaluate, Avoid, Defuse and Exit
- Buddy-buddy system
- Communication plan

FIGHT OF FLIGHT

- Increased blood flow, blood pressure, heart rate and respiration
- Blood clotting function speeds up, muscle tension increases, and pupils dilate
- We need to control our reaction to defuse a situation if it is too late to avoid it

CHANNELS OF COMMUNICATION



ESCALATION OF AGGRESSION

- Personal abuse
- Raised voice, increasingly vulgar and abusive language
- Redness of face, finger pointing, fist clenching
- Staring, leaning forward, agitation, invasion of personal space



DE-ESCALATING

- **P**osition
- **A**ttitude
- **L**ook and listen
- **M**ake space
- **S**tance



DEFUSING AGGRESSION

- Keep eye contact
- Use open-hand gestures
- Allow them to vent
- Do not block exit routes
- Step away and create space
- Do not turn your back



DISENGAGING

- Back away
- Keep them at arm's length
- Move lowered open hands to raise open hands
- Do not turn your back
- Go to a safe place



PREPARE FOR AN AGGRESSIVE INDIVIDUAL

- Research person, location, past behaviour and context
- Invite to neutral ground
- Identify escape routes
- Vehicle position
- Buddy-buddy system
- Likely escalation triggers

EXTRACTING FROM A CROWD

- Maintain situation awareness and know when to leave
- Communicate signs of danger and stick together
- Join together, lock arms at the elbow and move as one
- Snowplough together or back-to-back protecting head
- Shout '**BACK OFF**' and head to a safe area

SUMMARY

- Maintain situation awareness - **R**ecognise, **E**valuate, **A**void, **D**efuse, **E**xit
- Maintain a low profile, trust your instincts and don't get distracted
- Plan, prepare, communicate and rehearse potential scenarios
- Recognise early warning signs of escalating aggression
- Consider - **P**osition, **A**ttitude, **L**ook and listen, **M**ake space and **S**tance

TRAVEL SAFETY

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TAXIS

- Be aware who is picking you up, check identities, use registered airport taxis
- Ask driver for the name of who they are collecting, agree fare before you start, maybe photo registration and share
- Check child locks are not activated, but keep doors locked
- Sit behind the driver if travelling alone, have a rough idea of the direction and distance you need to travel, follow on a map and

WEAR SEATBELTS

ACCOMMODATION

- Lower profile hotel versus international brands
- Research the area of your accommodation
- Maybe select second or third floor if possible
- Room not near reception or front of building



ACCOMMODATION SAFETY

- Keep alert and responsive during check-in, keep control of baggage
- Consider door wedges, your own locks and smoke detector
- Know where your colleagues are and keep in communication
- Check the fire escapes and emergency evacuation routes, you might need to escape in the dark or through smoke



ACCOMMODATION SAFETY

- Thieves know all the hiding places and the room safe may not be safe
- Give the impression the room is occupied though the use of local TV, radio and the do not disturb sign
- Assess WiFi access and security

DIGITAL SAFETY - BEFORE YOU GO

- Take the least amount of devices
- Install software and OS update
- Change passwords and /or use a password manager
- Enable two-factor authentication
- Back up your data
- Sanitise devices and social media to clear them of sensitive data

DIGITAL SAFETY - DURING YOUR TRIP

- Avoid downloading in-country apps
- Turn off location tracking on all devices
- Turn off Bluetooth and Wi-Fi to the extent possible; connect to the Internet via a VPN
- Use private browsing mode and regularly clear the browser
- Do not plug devices into public charging stations
- Do not leave devices unattended at any time